

Change Management Communications (Template)

Step 4 · Solution Design

Plans users, UAT, communications, training, feedback loops, and resistance handling, started in Step 4, not at launch. Blank template; fill in your own domain's messages, channels, and signals. See the companion example for what a completed version looks like.

How to use this

Consistency matters as much as repetition. If the specific numbers or scope shift between messages, that inconsistency reads as uncertainty even when no one names it. State what the tool will not do, as clearly as what it will; unmet expectations, not the change itself, are what usually drive negative reactions after launch.

Communications, by phase

Phase	Message	Channel
Engage / Discovery	[Why this change is happening, and what role affected users will have in shaping it.]	[e.g. team meeting, sponsor message]
Build (before launch)	[What changes, specifically, starting on what date. What does not change.]	[e.g. team briefing, job aid, FAQ]
Launch and after	[Recurring update: consistent numbers, no shifting counts between messages.]	[e.g. office hours, dashboard link]

Resistance response plan

Signal	Likely cause	Response
[e.g. low active usage]	[trust gap, or workflow doesn't fit real cases]	[investigate specific cases, fix design gaps]
[e.g. workaround usage above X%]	[new process harder than old, for some or all cases]	[identify which cases; fix or document the exception path]
[e.g. minimal engagement after training]	[training gap, not a motivation problem]	[pair with a champion for one real task]

Sourced from the AIFT Playbook.